

the development of artificial intelligence radio access network (AI-RAN) technologies. Key objectives include supporting 5G and upcoming 6G networks by enabling AI-powered applications to drive differentiated services and unlock new revenue streams.

As part of this tie-up, AI technologies will run on Red Hat OpenShift within RAN infrastructures, allowing faster data processing, enhanced resource



optimisation, and improved network performance. This unified platform will also ensure intelligent automation and multi-layer security for service providers.

A Red Hat-sponsored study revealed that RAN accounts for 75% of a service provider's total energy consumption. By optimising resource and power usage, the AI-RAN solutions will help service

providers reduce energy consumption, aligning with sustainability goals.

Red Hat and SoftBank aim to deliver new AI use cases by fostering an open RAN ecosystem. As members of the AI-RAN Alliance, they will collaborate with industry partners and research institutions to advance research and validate proof-of-concept AI-RAN technologies.

Ryuji Wakikawa, vice president, head of research, Institute of Advanced Technology, SoftBank said: "We have newly designed and developed the orchestrator specific to the AI-RAN, showcasing our ability to operate this essential component. Our collaboration with Red Hat will accelerate the ongoing evolution of our platform, ensuring rapid advancements and contributing this innovation not just within SoftBank, but to the entire telecom industry."

The collaboration underscores the critical role of AI in shaping next-generation networks. By combining intelligent automation with enhanced network efficiency, Red Hat and SoftBank are paving the way for scalable, sustainable, and high-performing telecom infrastructures that support both providers and end users.

OpenELA releases enterprise Linux sources for RHEL 9.5

The Open Enterprise Linux Association (OpenELA) has released enterprise Linux sources compatible with Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL) 9.5. As a non-profit organisation, OpenELA provides independent software vendors (ISVs), hardware vendors, cloud service providers, telecommunications companies, government entities, and others with fast, secure, and free access to enterprise Linux sources for creating downstream builds.

Following Red Hat's release of RHEL 9.5 this November, OpenELA made the compatible sources available the next day, highlighting the effectiveness of their automated release process announced in July. This efficient approach ensures that builders of enterprise Linux distributions can quickly take advantage of the latest secure, open source versions of enterprise Linux.

The RHEL 9.5 repositories are available to the public at <https://github.com/orgs/openela-main/repositories>.

OpenELA exists to deliver open source code, tools, and systems to the community. It welcomes all organisations focused on reliable and secure access to enterprise Linux packages and build systems.

SUSE AI empowers enterprises with control, privacy, and trust in open source AI solutions

SUSE has launched SUSE AI, a trusted platform for deploying and running generative AI applications. SUSE AI is delivered as an integrated cloud-native solution, offering flexibility, extensibility, and access to leading large language models, allowing companies to retain control and sovereignty over their AI solutions.

As enterprises transition from AI experimentation to full deployment, security and compliance challenges often hinder progress, especially in highly regulated sectors like finance. Traditional AI solutions are often not designed with privacy in mind, forcing companies to develop custom solutions—a complex and time-consuming task. SUSE AI solves this by enabling private GenAI deployments that maintain high security without compromising on AI performance.

Developed with input from SUSE's AI Early Access Program, a collaboration with customers and partners, SUSE AI ensures secure and compliant generative AI solutions for enterprises. "AI is incredibly powerful, but without consideration, it has the potential to cause harm and damage reputations. As the value of GenAI - and the need for it - becomes more apparent, we are seeing customers struggle with compliance risks, shadow AI, and a lack of control, not to mention the vendor lock-in and skyrocketing costs associated with early-stage AI solutions," said Abhinav Puri, vice president of Portfolio Solutions at SUSE. "SUSE's approach to AI, delivered in our SUSE AI solutions and the SUSE AI Early Access Program, helps address these issues for customers."

Nidhi Srivastava, global head of AI.Cloud Offerings, TCS, said, "We are thrilled to partner with SUSE on the launch of its SUSE AI platform. Its new GenAI capabilities help to maintain security and sovereignty, which is essential in today's regulatory landscape."